

The Last Mile Shared Mobility Manifesto

“The Last Mile Shared Car”: A New Vision of Mobility

Preamble

The car is a wonderful means of transport. Since the end of the 19th century, it has gradually opened the way to an unparalleled freedom of movement, it has been the birthplace of cutting-edge technological innovation, it has fuelled our dreams and lifted our egos sky-high.

Our cities, our infrastructure and our societies have been built around the car. Our lives are organised outside urban centres, and sometimes far from our homes. But as the population grows, our dependence on the automobile produces the very opposite of the freedom we originally aspired to: congested city centres and saturated road networks are the daily reality of many car owners.

Yet many cars are rarely used. Most journeys carry a single person¹ to a nearby destination such as an office or a public transport hub. These journeys have nothing to do with the pleasure or the travel that made us love the car.

So the question deserves to be asked:

Should the freedom to travel still depend on owning a vehicle?

We believe it should not. The 21st century must redefine mobility.

Every era invents the infrastructure that matches its time, the technologies available and its human vision of progress. The railway connected cities. Air transport connected countries. The telephone connected people.

Our era gives us the opportunity to invent the mobility of tomorrow:

- Autonomous driving technology has reached a level of maturity sufficient for real, supervised deployments in urban and suburban areas at moderate speeds.
- Local authorities are looking for credible mobility solutions to reduce dependence on the private car, without the cost of heavy infrastructure.
- Users are increasingly familiar with on-demand services (ride-hailing, car sharing, delivery) — usage comes before technology.

So let us redefine mobility.

¹ [Mobilité des personnes | Données et études statistiques](#) (in French)

I. Mobility is a need. The car is one possible answer.

For decades, owning a car was the best way to meet a universal and legitimate need: to move around freely.

Today, this model is showing its limits in the context of our societies:

- A car is a major investment for a household, and its recurring costs weigh heavily on our quality of life
- It takes up considerable space in our cities, in our car parks and on our roads, creating the phenomenon known as “road network saturation”
- It sits idle for most of its life, and usually carries only one person, despite ever-increasing dimensions

We have made owning a car the precondition of our mobility. But the car is not the problem, and our ambition is not to do away with it. The problem lies in the way it is used. That needs to be rethought and optimised.

Our ambition is to reorganise the use of the car so as to increase its utilisation rate. Tomorrow, the car can become a shared service rather than an idle asset parked outside every home.

We propose to decouple ownership from mobility.

II. From ownership to access, for greater freedom

We have already been through this transformation at the cost of small changes in habit, and always in exchange for more simplicity and new possibilities:

- We no longer buy the films we watch
- We no longer buy the software we use
- We no longer buy the servers that host our photos and our data

We access services.

Mobility must follow the same path. The goal is no longer to own a vehicle; the goal is to access mobility, at any time, more simply. In doing so, we will broaden the range of possibilities:

- An elderly person regains their independence
- A teenager gets to their activities more easily
- A family can do without a second car
- A town reclaims space currently devoted to parking
- Everyone has easier access to public transport

Mobility becomes simpler because it becomes collective in its organisation, while remaining individual in the experience.

We do not claim that technology alone can solve car dependency. We are not replacing walking, cycling or public transport itself — we are strengthening them by removing their main point of friction.

III. The missing link

Public transport is the backbone of sustainable mobility:

- It is fast
- It is resource-efficient
- It is effective

Yet one obstacle remains:

How do you easily get from your home to a train station, a tram or a bus stop?

This first mile — and its counterpart, the last — still makes car ownership a necessity for millions of people.

Solving this problem will change the whole equation.

We propose to treat the first and last mile as public mobility infrastructure. We propose to integrate this infrastructure with the existing public transport infrastructure.

A fleet of shared, autonomous electric vehicles serves every neighbourhood, every home and every office building on demand. It connects residents to transport hubs:

- Trains, trams and buses cover long distances
- The shared vehicle covers short ones

Each mode is used where it performs best: competition gives way to complementarity.

IV. What sets us apart

We will avoid reproducing, with new technologies, the congestion we already know. That is not the goal. Autonomous first/last mile services already exist — in the form of fixed-route shuttles operated by local authorities in pilot areas (Atlanta, Tampa, Contra Costa...). These projects have proven the technical viability and the value of the concept. We aim to put technology at the service of a new mobility model.

It is a paradigm shift.

Autonomous vehicles are not an end in themselves: they are a means.

Technological progress becomes truly meaningful when it allows existing resources to be used better. Our proposal follows this logic:

- Fewer vehicles
- More mobility
- More freedom

Nor do we ignore the questions raised by vehicle autonomy: safety, social acceptance, regulatory framework, impact on drivers' jobs. These are issues we intend to address together with local authorities.

V. Our ambition

Mobility is an ecosystem; it can only evolve collectively, by involving all stakeholders. This transformation can only succeed if it brings together players who currently work separately:

- Local authorities
- Transport operators
- Manufacturers
- Researchers
- Urban planners
- Citizens

We are creating an open, collaborative project in which every partner, sponsor and promoter can contribute and share their vision and expectations.

Conclusion

The 20th century democratised the automobile. The 21st century will have to democratise mobility.

We imagine towns where owning a car is no longer a necessity. Cities where car parks become cultural spaces, schools, gardens or public squares. Regions where everyone can get around, whatever their age, income or physical ability.

This is not a break with the past, but the next step, in the continuity of progress. It is about a society where every home is naturally connected to the transport network, where mobility no longer depends on owning a vehicle, where technology serves people, giving them back time, space and freedom.

Mobility is a need.

Owning a car may no longer be the best answer.